

Prompts Explained

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REFERENCE VIDEOS

- AI Agent Prompting Masterclass: Beginner to Advanced (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bwrAsnU2P88) -- Nate Herk -- Watch for structured prompt components and the reactive prompting technique
- You SUCK at Prompting AI (Here's the secret) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pwWBcsxEoLk) -- Independent creator -- Watch for how the video frames the gap between what people do vs what actually works
- The Step-by-Step Masterclass on Writing Better Prompts (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FxP1O6Q07Go) -- Independent creator -- Watch for the layered structure approach and how context is added incrementally

THE ONE THING

Prompting is not about asking better questions -- it is about giving the model better starting conditions for its prediction, and that reframe changes every prompt decision you make.

HOOK

Everyone has been told to use better prompts. Nobody explains what that actually means. Here is the only prompting framework you need.

TARGET VIEWER

Someone who uses AI daily but writes prompts like they are typing a Google search -- one vague sentence -- and wonders why the output is always a bit off.

PAYOFF

The viewer can immediately write a structured prompt that gets consistently useful output, and understands WHY the structure works -- not just that it does. They will never write a one-line prompt again.

BEAT STRUCTURE

Beat -- Why Most Prompts Fail

Point: Most people prompt like they are Googling -- short, vague, no context. The model has nothing to predict from.

Visual: Screen recording: bad prompt ("write me a marketing email") vs structured prompt -- show the output quality difference side by side

Target words: ~120w

Beat -- What a Prompt Actually Is

Point: A prompt is the starting conditions for a prediction -- the more specific the conditions, the more specific and useful the prediction.

Visual: Simple diagram: prompt as input to the context window, model as predictor, output as the predicted continuation

Target words: ~160w

Beat -- The Three Elements

Point: Role, task, constraints -- give the model a persona, a clear job, and the limits of that job. Every effective prompt has all three.

Visual: Split screen showing the same request with and without each element added one at a time -- watch output improve each time

Target words: ~220w

Beat -- Context Is the Secret Weapon

Point: Pasting context -- who the audience is, what the goal is, what format you need -- is worth more than any template.

Visual: Live demo: add a context section to a plain prompt, watch output transform from generic to specific

Target words: ~180w

Beat -- CTA Bridge

Point: You can now prompt -- next is Claude specifically: which version to use, which products exist, and why most people only use 10 percent of what Claude can do.

Visual: Preview clip from Claude Explained

Target words: ~60w

ANALOGY BANK

- Prompting: Like briefing a contractor -- the more specific the brief (dimensions, materials, deadline), the better the result. 'Build me a shelf' gets you whatever they decide. 'Build a 6-foot oak shelf with 3 adjustable brackets' gets you what you want.
- Role in prompts: Like giving someone a job title before asking them a question -- 'as a lawyer' vs 'as a friend' gets completely different advice from the same person about the same situation.

THESIS LINE LOCATION

Beat 2 -- The insight is: prompts are starting conditions for prediction, not questions with right answers -- once you understand this, every prompt decision becomes obvious.

FRAMEWORK PHRASE

Role, task, constraints

SPECIFICITY BANK

- Anthropic publishes a prompt engineering guide at docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview
- Structural distinction: system prompts (set persona/context) vs user prompts (the actual request)
- Same structure principles apply across Claude, ChatGPT, and Gemini

CONSTRAINTS

- Do not go into advanced techniques -- chain-of-thought, few-shot examples, RAG
- Keep it actionable for daily use, not for building AI systems
- Avoid "prompt engineering" as jargon -- use plain language throughout
- This is not a comprehensive prompting course -- it is the 20% that delivers 80% of results

CTA DIRECTION

Now that you can prompt, the next video covers Claude specifically -- all its products, which model to use, and why most people only use 10 percent of what Claude can actually do.

PERSONAL ANGLE [DANIEL TO FILL]

Suggested: The first time you gave Claude a fully structured prompt instead of your usual vague request -- and the output difference was big enough to permanently change your habit.

VULNERABILITY MOMENT [DANIEL TO FILL]

Suggested: Spending 20 minutes editing a Claude output when the real fix was a better prompt -- the moment you realised you were fixing outputs instead of fixing inputs.

Note: belongs in Beat 1